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Examiners' Report
Summer 2026

GCSE History 1HI0 33

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Introduction

Examiners commented that most candidates seemed to find the paper accessible and were confident in tackling the various questions. They coped well with the range of question styles, which covered all four Assessment Objectives.

Questions on this paper cover all the Assessment Objectives but over half of the available marks are for question 3, which focuses on sources and interpretations. These questions form a coherent package leading to a final question in which candidates, having explored the utility of the provided sources, analyse the different views presented in the interpretations and the reasons for those differences, and are then invited to judge the extent to which they agree with one of the interpretations. It is therefore important that candidates appreciate the difference between sources and interpretations, and the focus of different parts of question 3.

In particular, there are still a number who find it difficult to explain why interpretations differ, question 3c. When they are asked about a reason for the different views, candidates should remember that the authors have constructed these interpretations and chosen to present them in this specific way. The most common explanation was that the authors had chosen to place weight on different sources, but it is important to support this with details from the interpretations and the sources in order to meet the mark scheme requirement that 'An explanation of a reason for difference is given, **analysing the interpretations**. The explanation is **substantiated effectively'**. It should also be noted that it is not possible to provide effectively substantiated reasons why the interpretations are different, based on such things as where and when the interpretations were published, unless it is assumed that everyone writing in a specific year shared the same view.

The focus of question 3d is on the interpretations and candidates who provide their own view of the issue in the question are unlikely to access the higher levels of the mark scheme. Similarly, every level of the mark scheme above Level 1 refers to 'interpretations'. There is no expectation that both interpretations are dealt with in equal depth, but both should be examined explicitly. Answers which only analyse one interpretation can score above Level 1 if they perform well in other strands of the mark scheme but are unlikely to achieve a high mark.

The use of contextual knowledge is an important element in this evaluation, but it must be precisely selected to support the evaluation and not just used to display knowledge of aspects of the topic which the candidate has revised but which are not relevant to the enquiry. Candidates should be reminded that the content from the sources provided may be used to provide contextual knowledge for the interpretations.

Candidates have already explained the difference between the interpretations in question 3b and will have used this knowledge in their answer to question 3c as they review the alternative views being offered. A feature of strong answers is to show an understanding of how the authors have conveyed their different views. This could be through their use of language, the tone of their writing, their choice of details to include or omit, or their decision of how to present their material. Answers just need to show an understanding that the author has chosen what language to use or what to emphasise; they do not need to judge how effective this. This is even more effective if it is worked into the answer rather than left as a stand-alone comment. For example, 'the author presents this as a positive aspect', 'the interpretation focuses on … and omits …', 'the language is very critical' or 'only including this at the end plays down its significance'.

A full range of responses suggest this question was accessible to candidates of all abilities and full answers were generally provided, showing that timing wasn't generally an issue on this paper.

Question 1

This question requires candidates to make two inferences from a source and it is sometimes regarded as an 'easy' question. However, candidates need to be sure that the inferences they make from the source are not based on their own knowledge as this question assesses AO3 and no marks are available for AO1 (knowledge and understanding). They also need to ensure the inferences they make relate to the enquiry in the question.

The focus of the question was about the Black Panther Party. There were two marks available for each valid inference – one for the inference itself and one for the supporting information. Most candidates seemed to understand how to make an inference, and most used the content of the source to provide support for the inference. Such candidates tended to make inferences regarding the willingness of the Black Panther Party to use violence or their feeling that the police did not treat Black people fairly. Quite a number of candidates did not write an inference about the Black Panther Party. Instead, they made inferences about Black people more generally. This was not the focus of the question. It was also noteworthy that a significant number of candidates used their own knowledge about the Black Panther Party, rather than making an actual inference. It should be recognised that details from the source can only be rewarded if they are provided as support for an inference. No marks were available for candidates who provided basic summaries of the content of the source.

1 Give **two** things you can infer from Source A about the Black Panther Party.

Complete the table below to explain your answer.

(i) What I can infer:

I can infer that they believe the Prison System is unjust.

Details in the source that tell me this:

"Should be released from Prison because they have not recieved a fair trail."

(ii) What I can infer:

I can infer that the Black panthers want to fight back against the police

Details in the source that tell me this:

"all black people Should arm themselves for Self - defence."

(Total for Question 1 = 4 marks)

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Examiner Comments

Both inferences are valid and appropriate support from the source is provided. 4 marks were awarded.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Tip

Candidates should ensure that the inferences are genuine inferences and not just things they know about the Black Panther Party.

1 Give **two** things you can infer from Source A about the Black Panther Party.

Complete the table below to explain your answer.

(i) What I can infer:

I can infer that it was common for black people to be wrongly prisoned.

Details in the source that tell me this:

'not received a fair trail' meaning they may be innocent.

(ii) What I can infer:

Black people were commonly abused by police

Details in the source that tell me this:

'self defence groups to defend our black community from racist police violence', the need of the group must mean it was common.

(Total for Question 1 = 4 marks)

ResultsPlus

Examiner Comments

Neither inference is valid as neither is about the Black Panther Party. They are general statements about Black Americans.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Tip

Candidates should ensure they understand exactly what the inferences need to be about, in this case the Black Panther Party.

Question 2(a)

In question 2, the focus will always be on causation but the question does not require a judgement to be made or for the answer to prioritise or show interaction of factors and no marks were available to reward such evaluation, however strongly argued. Instead, the most successful candidates showed a consistent analytical focus throughout their answers and many were able to access Level 4 by doing so.

The stimulus points in the question will often be useful reminders to candidates of specific areas of content about which they can write. Candidates do not need to use these stimulus points but there is an expectation that there will be some depth of knowledge at the higher levels, shown by three discrete aspects of content being covered, although this does not mean they need to identify three different causes or events.

A number of answers remained at Level 3, despite excellent knowledge, because they missed the focus of the question. The mark scheme's bullet point for Assessment Objective 2 (analysis) at Level 4 expects an analytical explanation, directed consistently at the conceptual focus of the question. Candidates who responded to the topic rather than the key idea were unlikely to achieve high marks. Those who did reach Level 4 realised that the topic provides the context but that there is a specific focus, which the analysis should address.

Question 2a was the most popular of the 2 options, and was focused on why the USA became more involved in the conflict in Vietnam in the years 1954–63. Although many candidates were able to provide at least two paragraphs regarding involvement, there were many occasions where candidates provided a narrative of what happened in the early stages of American involvement in Vietnam. Most candidates did have good knowledge of the Domino Theory, one of the stimulus points, and this regularly appeared as a strength. A significant number of candidates just wrote about the Domino Theory and Kennedy and did not discuss a third aspect of content, which limited their marks to mid level 3. Most answers which had three factors covered were able to get into L3 or L4 for AO1. The better answers included specific examples and developed their points. Candidates were able to sustain their focus on the question and include analytical explanations. Strong responses often discussed France pulling out of Vietnam and the reliance of South Vietnam on the USA for aid.

This question was answered well on the whole, with the level of knowledge in answers rarely going below Level 2. In many cases the knowledge strand was the stronger of the two.

Indicate which question you are answering by marking a cross in the box ☒. If you change your mind, put a line through the box ☒ and then indicate your new question with a cross ☒.

Chosen question number: **Question 2(a)** ☒ **Question 2(b)** ☒

Write your answer here:

One reason that the USA became more involved with the conflict in Vietnam- in 1954-63 was ~~the~~ the domino ~~theory~~ theory. This is because President Eisenhower believed that if one country fell to ~~Vietnam~~ communism that other countries would also potentially became communist. This lead to more involvement as the President wanted to prevent this spread of communism as then they will soon lose the ongoing Cold War ~~against~~ against the USSR.

Another reason that the USA became more involved with the conflict in Vietnam in 1954-63 was President Kennedy. This is because Kennedy ~~sent~~ sent American Advisors to South Vietnam to train the army, the ARVN to prepare for an invasion and the ~~introduction~~ introduction of the Stratigic Hamlet Programme. This meant that the USA could be preparing to take back control from the Vietminh and the Stratigic Hamlet programme shows that Kennedy is attempting to limit the spread of the idea of communism to the South Vietnamese.

The Final reason why the USA became more involved with the conflict ~~of~~ in Vietnam in 1954-63 was the Gulf of Tonkin incident. This is because of an American warship patrolling off the Gulf of Tonkin

experienced thunder but assumed it was ~~a~~ enemies attacked and reported it to congress and it lead to the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution signed by Congress. This meant that President Johnson is now able to send troops into Vietnam to take over North Vietnam which lead to ~~more~~ conflict between American troops and ARVN against the Vietminh and Vietcong.

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Examiner Comments

This answer achieved a level 3 mark. An explanation is given, showing some analysis, which is mainly directed at the conceptual focus of the question. It shows a line of reasoning that is generally sustained. Accurate and relevant information is included, showing good knowledge and understanding of the required features or characteristics of the period studied. However, the answer only discussed two relevant aspects of content, as the Tet Offensive was out of the date range. This limited the mark to mid-level 3.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Tip

Make sure you explain clearly how the points you are making answer the question.

Indicate which question you are answering by marking a cross in the box ☒. If you change your mind, put a line through the box ☒ and then indicate your new question with a cross ☒.

Chosen question number: **Question 2(a)** ☒ **Question 2(b)** ☐

Write your answer here:

The USA increased their involvement in the conflict in Vietnam as a result of Ho Chi Minh's growing popularity. During the battle of Bien Diem Phu in 1954, Ho Chi Minh led Vietnam to victory through the use of his organisation, known as the Vietminh. Victory was achieved using geogcaphical advantages and focus on surprising the French, who believed the vietnamese were unprepared for their attack. The Vietminh also recieved aid from China, a highly Communist country. this not only resulted in brief independence for Vietnam but long term involvement with the US, which feared that Vietnam would become communist under Ho Chi Minh's leadership. The US decided to increase involvement by setting up the Geneva Accords and providing support for South Vietnam and it's leader Diem, by sending advisors to train the South Vietnamese army.

Alongside this, involvement increased in the conflict in Vietnam due to Eisenhower's fears of communism and Domino theory. Domino theory was the idea that communist countries were convincing Vietnam

to switch to a communist rule, resulting in other southeast Asian countries following their example. This idea meant that the USA needed to increase involvement to stop the spread of communism over time, leading to ~~Johnson~~ Eisenhower providing millions of dollars in funding to South Vietnam in order to prepare their army for attacks.

Finally, the USA increased involvement regarding conflict in Vietnam due to the control the vietcong had in the south. After Diem was taken out of power in South Vietnam, the country became increasingly weak, ~~weakth~~ causing villages to become overun with Vietcong members using gerilla tactics to hide in plain sight. ~~Pres~~ During the early 1960's, President Kennedy aimed to solve this issue by introducing Strategic hamlets, guarded villages set up by the ARVN in order to protect villagers from the Vietcong. This decision to increase conflict involvement meant that North Vietnamese control could be contained and prevented by keeping ~~rural areas under sur~~ civillians in artificial villages guarded by soldiers.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Comments

This response received a high level 4 mark. An analytical explanation was given, it was coherent and logically structured and accurate and relevant information was precisely selected to address the question.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Tip

You don't need to write down everything you know about a topic, just ensure that the material you select is appropriate and is focused on answering the question.

Question 2(b)

Question 2b was marginally the least popular of the 2 options, and was focused on why there was opposition in the USA to the Vietnam War in the years 1964–75. Many candidates answered this question very well satisfying the requirements of both AO1 and AO2. Candidates often demonstrated excellent knowledge of the My Lai massacre, the draft system and the Tet Offensive and could link these to growing opposition to the war. The best responses not only demonstrated excellent knowledge of the possible reasons for opposition to the war but were also able to link those reasons to the growing unpopularity of the war. This led to some sophisticated reasoning especially around the draft and the impact of the Tet Offensive.

High-level responses went beyond the material provided, introducing additional relevant factors such as the Tet Offensive, the economic impacts of the war, the counter-culture movement and the Kent State University shootings. By contrast, weaker responses tended to describe the stimulus points without really analysing why they led to opposition. There were very few weak responses as most candidates were able to discuss at least one reason for opposition.

Indicate which question you are answering by marking a cross in the box ☒. If you change your mind, put a line through the box ☒ and then indicate your new question with a cross ☒.

Chosen question number: **Question 2(a)** ☒ **Question 2(b)** ☒

Write your answer here:

One reason there was opposition in the USA to the Vietnam war is My Lai massacre. This was when American soldiers were set to go to pinkville village and destroy, kill anything that was there. Therefore, this led to many children and innocent to die. This created an opposition because it was published on television across the world portraying a bad image of the Americans. Furthermore, this shows that it was a pointless war to the people because both countries are being negatively effected due to this war.

Additionally, another reason there was a opposition in the USA to the Vietnam war is the draft system. This was when the Americans started to pick their people et to join the war however the drafted people were mostly black people and it could be avoid if you were rich. Therefore, this creates an opposition against the war because many black people were campaigning against the drafts as they were poorly treated by the Americans why would

they go to fight for mem. Furthermore, this shows to the people mat the Americans were losing the war against the Vietnam so the people wanted the American soldiers out of the war.

Lastly, Another reason ~~the USA~~ there was an opposition in the USA to the Vietnam war is the troubles that they were facing in American. This was when black people were protesting against there housing conditions in many cities. This creates opposition because the Americans want the government to solve their problems instead of erecting more with the war.

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Examiner Comments

This answer achieved a high level 3 mark. Good knowledge and understanding of the features/period was shown and there was some analysis mainly directed at the focus of the question.

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Examiner Tip

Make sure you address the focus of the question and not just the topic.

Indicate which question you are answering by marking a cross in the box ☒. If you change your mind, put a line through the box ☒ and then indicate your new question with a cross ☒.

Chosen question number: **Question 2(a)** ☒ **Question 2(b)** ☒

Write your answer here:

One reason there was opposition to the USA in the Vietnam war, was the draft system of young Americans. The draft system meant people from the US were conscripted to fight in the Vietnam War, without the choice to decline. These young men were often undereducated and as a result, were unsure as to what they were getting themselves into. As LB. Johnson needed troops more immediately after the Gulf of Tonkin event, training time was very short, and soldiers were also inexperienced. Furthermore, as many soldiers did not want to participate, morale was low, and drug use was high - especially heroin towards the end of the war. ~~Therefore all of these~~. Fragging also became common amongst US troops, as they did not want to fight. Therefore, because the draft system lead to opposition, ~~was~~ not only did troops reject their participation, but families at home, and the US nation, saw it as unfair and

civel. Due to this internal opposition of troops, the death toll ~~of~~ of US sodiers was very high, which also grew opposition back in America.

A second reason, was the My Lai Massacre in 1968. This event is where the US attacked a South Vietnamese village to drive out the Vietcong and prevent them recruiting more members. Despite around 120 Vietcong members being killed, some innocent villagers were also killed, including a young boy. Due to the increase in media thraghout the war, it presented the US the extent of violence, which increased opposition. The wide range use of televisions, as they were becoming ~~more~~ more popular meant people could view these events from the luxury of their living rooms. Moreover, one soldier, Calley, was sentenced for murder of the villagers, despite following orders. This further increased opposition as people saw the US government as liers, and violent. Therefore opposition grew because the event in My Lai reflected

the US's harsh stance on Vietnam, and the increased use of violence they continue to adopt. As well as this, media coverage intensified opposition as people could see the cruelty.

A third reason, was the Kent state shootings in June 1970. On the first of June, University students of Kent began to protest and their actions in Vietnam against the government. Over the next 3 days, the crowds increased, growing to around 50,000 people. The National Guard were sent in to protect other Civilians and maintain the mass number of protestors. On the 4th of June, warning shots were fired, in which 4 people were killed, and around 100 were injured. This government violence further intensified opposition, linking to the increase in the use of violence in the My Lai Massacre. This event of Kent shooting, and the My Lai Massacre, increased public outrage, and opposition to the government, and involvements in because Vietnam. Therefore opposition grew, deaths and violence was starting to spread to the US itself, which made them look weak to the rest of the world, especially during the cold war.

(Total for Question 2 = 12 marks)

TOTAL FOR SECTION A = 16 MARKS

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Examiner Comments

This response received a high level 4 mark. An analytical explanation was given, it was coherent and logically structured and accurate and relevant information was precisely selected to address the question.

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Examiner Tip

Make sure each point is explained (not just stated) and try to include precise details to support each point of analysis.

Question 3(a)

Question 3 (a) targets the ability to analyse and evaluate source utility and, in doing so, introduces the enquiry which will be dealt with in further detail in questions 3(b), 3(c) and 3(d).

In question 3 (a) candidates are expected to evaluate the usefulness of the content, taking account of the provenance of the sources and applying contextual knowledge in making judgements about the utility of the sources as evidence for the specific enquiry, in this case the progress in education for Black Americans in the years 1954–62. These strands in the mark scheme are linked and should be dealt with together, rather than in isolation.

Successful candidates explained what each source revealed about progress and resistance to desegregation before considering how the purpose, nature and origin of each source affected usefulness. Contextual knowledge was integrated directly into the evaluation.

Weaker answers described the sources without evaluating their usefulness or made generic comments about provenance. Many did not recognise the significance of the year source C was documented. Others added contextual knowledge separately without linking it to the usefulness of the sources.

Candidates found the sources accessible, particularly Source B which is a well-known image, and were confident in showing that the content of the sources was relevant for the enquiry and therefore useful. They could also make a number of points about the significance of the provenance for the usefulness of the content, although sometimes this consisted of basic statements rather than a developed explanation. When considering provenance, generic comments about a source being biased (with no explanation of how that bias could be detected or why it occurred) or about the source being reliable because it came from the time under investigation, could be made without any reference to the individual source and therefore remained at Level 1. This type of generic assumption was seen when some answers assumed that the authors of the sources would be biased or that a source's accuracy would be affected by the passage of time.

At Level 2, developed comments were made about the content of the sources, for example, the evidence source B provided about the mob in the picture expressing aggressive opposition to desegregation. This was often backed up by contextual knowledge about the reasons for this, including detailed knowledge of the 'Little Rock Nine'.

There were also good comments made about the provenance of the sources, for example that Source B was from a newspaper and therefore shows what a significant event this was.

However, some very good answers could not access the higher marks because they did not include contextual knowledge. Contextual knowledge is mentioned at every level of the mark scheme and failure to include it limited a number of otherwise good answers. Candidates should recognise that it is not enough to repeat a detail from the source and assert that this can be confirmed from the candidate's own knowledge or to give generalised comments such as "I know that the 'Little Rock Nine' faced opposition to them attending the school". Some additional detail is needed as a demonstration of that own knowledge. Contextual knowledge should be relevant to the enquiry and used to assess the source, for example to add detail about something mentioned in the source,

to add weight to an aspect of the provenance, to place the source in a broader context, or to assess whether the source gave an accurate view or showed a typical situation.

At Level 3, comments need to consider the effect of an aspect of the provenance on the usefulness of the source content, and contextual knowledge should be integrated into the process of reaching a judgement, not simply provided as information.

It is important to note that the question asks about the usefulness of the sources in relation to a specific enquiry. Sources should not be dismissed because they do not cover every detail that might be helpful in an investigation and candidates should recognise that unreliable sources can be very useful.

Similarly, the focus should be on assessing the usefulness of what is in the source rather than listing details which are not mentioned. It can be valid to note the limitations of a source but these points need to be used in an overall evaluation of the usefulness of the source; an answer which focuses on 'missing' information without weighing the positive aspects of the source, is unlikely to score highly. If the answer identifies omissions from the source as limitations on its usefulness, this could be linked to a consideration of the provenance, showing whether this is the result of lack of knowledge or deliberate omission.

The question asks 'how useful' the sources are, so a judgement should be made on the usefulness of the source's evidence for the specific enquiry. Good answers made clear the criteria being used to assess the usefulness for the enquiry of the sources, weighing the value of the content in the light of the provenance and the candidate's own knowledge. Various criteria could be used, for example accuracy of detail, reliability, the relevance of the source, the way it could be used by the historian, or how representative the source is.

Very few answers only considered one source but it should be noted that every level of the mark scheme refers to 'sources' and therefore answers which do not consider both sources cannot access high marks.

SECTION B

For this section, you will need to use the sources and interpretations in the Sources/Interpretations Booklet.

3 (a) **Study Sources B and C.**

How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into progress in education for Black Americans in the years 1954–62?

Explain your answer, using Sources B and C and your knowledge of the historical context.

(8)

Source B is useful for an enquiry into progress in education because it shows the difficulties black students had to face ~~to~~ in order to gain education. This is because the image of Elizabeth Eckford shows her being verbally abused by ~~a group of~~ a white mob. The fact that it was published on the front page of a local newspaper suggests it was a major event that gained a massive attention. It was also published in national newspapers, which means it would have raised awareness on civil rights & to people ~~around the~~ in other parts of the country. The image was published in 1957, ~~when Governor Faubus ordered~~ when Elizabeth Eckford was supposed to arrive to school in an NAACP bus with 9 other students but didn't receive the message so came alone - causing her to be abused by white people. This exemplifies how even small misunderstandings could cause ~~a~~ major problems for young black people who simply wanted an education. Being on the front page, the purpose of this source ~~must have~~ was

most likely to raise awareness about issues regarding Black education.

Source C is useful because it shows ~~the success~~ one of the successes of the legal system regarding Black education. This is because the source describes how James Meredith, rejected by the University of Mississippi in 1961, was finally accepted in 1962. I know this was because the NAACP claimed the rejection was due to his race and was a vidation of Brown vs Topeka 1954. The source is useful as it quotes the words of a leading civil rights campaigner who was a member of the NAACP. ~~This suggests the source is accurate~~ Therefore the source accurately ~~reports~~ reflects the reaction of ~~on~~ the NAACP to the success of James Meredith, as well as the attitudes of civil rights campaigners towards progress in education. The interview was used ~~in television~~ on television, suggesting its purpose was to ~~encourage people about the civil~~ educate and raise awareness about the civil rights movements' struggles regarding education. Being broadcasted in 1987, it was many years after the event. By then, ~~people had the~~ society had become much more accepting of Black people and the civil rights movement had achieved many victories, so this interview would've been ~~more accepted by the~~ listened to by the public.

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Examiner Comments

Level 3 is achieved for both sources. The candidate uses contextual knowledge to effectively evaluate the content of the sources, not just as evidence of what they know. Reasoning takes into account how the provenance affects the content of the sources.

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Examiner Tip

Rather than making several points about the source content, make sure you cover content, provenance and contextual knowledge.

SECTION B

For this section, you will need to use the sources and interpretations in the Sources/Interpretations Booklet.

3 (a) Study Sources B and C.

How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into progress in education for Black Americans in the years 1954–62?

Explain your answer, using Sources B and C and your knowledge of the historical context.

(8)

Source B is useful in telling us that there was some progress regarding education for Black Americans. Before 1957, many Black children wouldn't have even attempted to enter a 'White school'. Many Black children would have to travle long, long distances to even bee able to acsess simple education. So Source B tells us that Elizabeth Eckford was refusing to follow their racist laws, I also knowk there was 8 other children who also took a stand. However in the Photograph D I can see grown women and men all surrounding Elizabeth as she walks in. I know that Elizabeth faced lots of verbel abuse of White women. This tells me that even though they were accepted into the school, there was white people who were strongly against. This tells me that their was some progress but it wasn't for Black Americans as a whole.

Source C is useful in telling me that there was progress regarding education for Black Americans. ~~In how the source~~ This is evident in the source where it says, 'In 1962 when James Meredith finally joined the university of Missisipi'. This shows the importance of taking a stand and refusing to bind to their racist laws, as it leads to progress. I know when James Meredith tried to register in the begining, hundreds of people turned were against it, many people even ~~ted~~ to violence. Which caused President Kennedy to be aware of the situation, and send 500 troops to protect James Meredith. This ~~thight~~ foreshadowed the ongoing Progress Black Americans will have with education. This is also evident in the source where it says, 'we were not just talking about one man's education, but would happen for future generations. This showed on-going determin~~ation~~ for and ~~for~~ ongoing progress.

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Examiner Comments

Level 2 is achieved for both sources. The candidate evaluates the sources in terms of accuracy, using contextual knowledge to test the content of the sources. No analysis of the provenance of either source is evident.

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Examiner Tip

E valuate the provenance rather than just repeating the attribution

Question 3(b)c

In this question, candidates are asked to identify a difference in the overall views being offered in the interpretations; these do not necessarily contradict each other but they do provide alternative views. The answers should identify the key difference but also provide support from each interpretation to demonstrate that difference.

Many answers recognised that the two interpretations offered different views about the progress in education for Black Americans in the years 1954–62 and could select detail from the two interpretations to support the explanation of that difference. The vast majority identified the difference as being how much progress had been made. However, some answers simply selected details from the interpretations without explaining how these demonstrated the difference in the overall views.

It is important for candidates to remember that the focus of this question is to identify the differences between the views rather than identifying differences of surface detail as the latter can only be awarded marks in Level 1. Responses which asserted differences without support, for example stayed in level 1.

Level 2 was achieved when the candidates indicted a clear difference of view and supported it with detail from the extracts. It was pleasing to see that many candidates were able to score full marks.

It is important that candidates recognise the relationship between questions 3b and 3c. Having identified that the two interpretations offer different views, candidates are asked to suggest a reason why these different views have been reached. They should be able to support their answer with reference to the interpretations but they should also make sure that their answer to 3(c) does not simply repeat their answer to 3(b).

There was little change from last year in terms of the ability of candidates to explain the difference of view. A large number understood that historians use sources as the building blocks to form views and interpretations. These candidates often used Sources B and C to exemplify this historical process. They were able to explain the difference in view in terms of the historians giving weight to different evidence. However, a significant minority of candidates still do not answer this question effectively and are still making assertions about the publication date or title of the book being of significance without being able to prove this.

The focus here is on the process by which the historian produces their interpretation. Where answers suggested that when carrying out research, the authors had placed weight on different sources, candidates could easily score the full 4 marks by linking details in the interpretations with details in Sources B and C. However, this should be explained with references to both the interpretations and the sources rather than simply stating that 'the author of Interpretation 1 might have used Source B'. They should also try to avoid statements such as 'Interpretation 2 supports Source C' as this suggests they have not understood the relationship between the sources and the interpretations.

Alternative explanations also recognise that the historian's approach may affect their research and conclusions. For example, whether an historian focuses on economic or political impacts. Here again, the explanation needs to be supported by the use of the interpretations. In this case, there was also the opportunity for candidates to recognise that the focus might be different as the historians were focused on different events. Therefore, speculation that the difference in interpretation is a result of their provenance, for example the date that the interpretations were produced, is not valid as it cannot be supported with explicit details. The full reasons for this are explained in the *Getting*

Started Guide on pp 43–44. As stated in *Getting Started*: 'Students should distinguish between their comments on contemporary sources and on these texts. Responses based on matters such as the origin or time of production of these secondary works are unlikely to be valid for this question.'

(b) **Study Interpretations 1 and 2.**

They give different views about progress in education for Black Americans in the years 1954–62.

What is the main difference between these views?

Explain your answer, using details from **both** interpretations.

1 view quote
2 view quote

(4)

Interpretation 1 gives the negative view that there was no progress in education for Black Americans in the years 1954–62. A quote to support this is "no Black children attending school with white children 6 years after Brown vs. Topeka".

Interpretation 2 gives the positive view that there was progress in education for Black Americans in the years 1954–62. A quote to support this is "in 1958, the Supreme court said that any attempt to keep schools segregated went against the American constitution".

interpretation quote

(c) Suggest **one** reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about progress in education for Black Americans in the years 1954–62.

You **may** use Sources B and C to help explain your answer.

(4)

Interpretations 1 and 2 are different because they give different weight to different sources.

Interpretation 1 gives weight to source B as in interpretation 1, it claims "white southern leaders promised to resist desegregation", and in source B it shows Elizabeth Eckford surrounded by an angry crowd of white Americans following and abusing her, not to let her in.

Interpretation 2 gives weight to source C as it claimes that "there was some change in civil rights" and source C states "merredith's achievement gave us, as Black people, more determination to keep working for progress in civil rights."

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Examiner Comments

The answer achieved L2 for both b and c.
The answer for question 3b shows clear analysis of the interpretations. A key difference in view has been identified and supported with evidence from both interpretations.
The answer for question 3c has given a valid reason for the difference in view and has been able to evidence that reason from the interpretations.

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Examiner Tip

Make sure you are able to evidence the reason you have given. It is not necessary to provide quotes as long as you are able to evidence clearly the content of the interpretations and sources.

(b) **Study Interpretations 1 and 2.**

They give different views about progress in education for Black Americans in the years 1954–62.

What is the main difference between these views?

Explain your answer, using details from **both** interpretations.

(4)

Interpretation 1 believes that there was no change in education after the Brown vT Topeka case this can be proven with, "Six years after the Brown vT Topeka ruling, there were still no ~~white~~ black children attending school with white children." Whereas Interpretation 2 believes that there was change in education after Brown vT Topeka this can be proven with "This then encouraged ~~other~~ other Black students to apply to university

(c) Suggest **one** reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about progress in education for Black Americans in the years 1954–62.

You **may** use Sources B and C to help explain your answer.

(4)

Many Historians have diffferent views and opinions so can assest what people believe. One reason Interpretation 1 and 2 have diffferent opinions is because they are talking about diffferent types of educations. Interpretation is talking about High School and Interpretations 2 is talking about University

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Examiner Comments

In question 3b, the candidate achieves full marks as they have understood the difference of view and have evidenced this understanding from the content of the interpretations.
In question 3c, the candidate indicates that the historian has focused on different types of education which is a valid comment, but this is not effectively substantiated so the mark stays in level 1.

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Examiner Tip

Make sure you can evidence the reason you give for the difference in views. Don't just speculate.

Question 3(d)

Question 3 (d) carries the highest number of marks on the paper. Successful candidates will have already seen how the views in the interpretations are different, why this might be the case and, in completing 3(a) have understood that there is likely to be evidence in support of both interpretations. They are now asked how far they agree with one of the interpretations. In this case the view they are being asked to evaluate is that there was some progress in education for Black Americans. The strongest answers to 3(d), therefore, focused clearly on the interpretations themselves, reviewing the alternative views and coming to a substantiated judgement. Candidates need to recognise that they are not being asked to treat the interpretation as a source and evaluate its reliability or usefulness but to explain whether they think the historian has offered a valid view.

The use of contextual knowledge is an important element in every level of the mark scheme but it must be precisely selected and linked to the evaluation of the interpretation rather than being offered as an answer to the enquiry question. At the same time, merely asserting agreement with points in the interpretation by saying 'from my own knowledge I know this to be true' is not sufficient evidence of contextual knowledge.

Candidates often used details from Interpretation 1 to counter the view in Interpretation 2. At all levels of the mark scheme answers are expected to analyse both interpretations and discuss the difference in the views being offered, so answers should be explicit in their references to the Interpretations rather than presenting this as their own knowledge. As stated above, the interpretations do not need to be dealt with in equal depth but both should be examined explicitly.

Examiners reported some impressive answers to 3(d) and many candidates were able to engage confidently with the interpretations, taking a range of approaches. In addition, some of the strongest answers were able to show how the differences of view in the two interpretations were conveyed, for example through the use of language, tone, selection or omission of detail, or emphasis created by the structure of the interpretation.

It is expected that candidates will reach a judgement when answering this question and the strongest developed their evaluation throughout the answer, creating a consistently argued response. Less successful answers offered points to support the views expressed in interpretation 2, then used interpretation 1 and contextual knowledge to challenge those views, before reaching the view that interpretation 2 was 'somewhat accurate' or saying that they 'partially agreed with the view in Interpretation 2'. In these answers, there was little sense of evaluation, merely an explanation of the different views, with the acknowledgement that each had some valid points. The strongest answers to question 3(d), therefore, focused clearly on the interpretations themselves, integrating evaluation while reviewing the alternative views and coming to a substantiated judgement. Candidates who focused exclusively on the view provided in interpretation 2 and used this as a basis for an essay based on their own knowledge were less successful. The existence of the strands which make up AO4 leads to 'best-fit marking'. All strands are considered before a final mark is decided upon. The most successful candidates, therefore, were able to display evidence of a clear understanding of all three strands:

· the quality of the judgement based on reasoning

· the analysis of the provided interpretations

· the deployment of contextual knowledge to support the application of criteria.

Candidates who examine precise details from the interpretations and then use their own knowledge to support these points are more likely to gain the higher levels.

Spelling, punctuation, grammar and use of specialist terminology will be assessed in part (d).

(d) How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about progress in education for Black Americans in the years 1954–62? 2x P QA J QAJ OJ + conclusion

Explain your answer, using **both** interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context.

(16)

~~I strongly agree~~ In Interpretation 1, it talks about the lack of progression in education ~~for~~ Black Americans. "Six years after Brown v Topeka ... still no Black children attending school together with white children [in the south]". ~~This is so~~ From my own knowledge, this is ~~mostly~~ very accurate as most schools, especially in the south, started to desegregate one ~~a~~ school year at a ~~the~~ time so avoided it completely. I somewhat disagree with Interpretation 2 as Interpretation 1 shows the reality of desegregation in schools. "Southern leaders promised to resist desegregation". From my own knowledge, this is ~~accurate very~~ mostly accurate as Govenor Faubus sent state troops to 'protect' the black students from the mob but in reality he was likely trying to stop ~~desegregation~~ integration. I somewhat ~~agree~~ ~~disagree~~ agree with Interpretation 2 as Interpretation 1 is correct that there was ~~a~~ southern resistance from ~~the~~ leaders that didn't stop the Little Rock 9 getting in the next day. Overall, I somewhat ~~disagree~~ agree with ~~the~~ Interpretation 2 as while there was ~~lots~~ ~~less~~ people protesting against the progression it did not stop or reverse it.

In Interpretation 2, it talks about the success of the James Meredith incident - "He got legal aid from NAACP lawyers" leading to a "Supreme Court decision in his favour". From my own knowledge, this is very accurate as James Meredith ~~was, and others black people,~~ was allowed to go to the University of Mississippi due to the National Association of the Advancement of Colored People being an organisation that fought for desegregation in court. I strongly agree with Interpretation 2 as it shows how the small but important progress went. "Supreme Court said ... any attempt to keep schools segregated went against the ... Constitution". From my own knowledge, this is mostly accurate as ~~they did~~ the Supreme Court did agree that it broke the 14th Amendment but did little to inforce this rule. I somewhat ~~strongly~~ disagree with Interpretation 2 as it shows ~~not~~ so only ~~some of~~ on part of the ruling and not the aftermath. Overall, I somewhat agree with Interpretation 2 as it actually shows the ~~progression~~ forward Progression but fails to 'paint' the whole 'picture'.

Finally, overall, I strongly agree with Interpretation 2 as it, unlike Interpretation 1, it shows progression in education while Interpretation 1 only shows ~~progress in the~~ the lack of progress in the south.

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Examiner Comments

This response achieved level 2 for the judgement strand of AO4 as the evaluation was asserted rather than explained. In the other strands of AO4 the answer achieved level 3. Good analysis of the interpretations is shown indicating difference of view and deploying this to support the evaluation. Relevant contextual knowledge is used directly to support the evaluation. The overall mark was high level 3.

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Examiner Tip

Know what your judgement is before you start to write your answer. In this way, you can build up a coherent answer, with a consistent line of reasoning.

Spelling, punctuation, grammar and use of specialist terminology will be assessed in part (d).

(d) How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about progress in education for Black Americans in the years 1954–62?

Explain your answer, using **both** interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context.

PQAJ QAJ OJ

(16)

I mostly agree with Interpretation 1 about the progress in education for Black Americans from 1954 - 62. Interpretation 1 states that "White Southern leaders promised to resist desegregation." From my own knowledge, I know this is accurate because after ~~desegregation was~~ in education was deemed unconstitutional ~~and it was~~ in 1954, schools were required to desegregate, ~~however~~ many Southern Leaders called for massive resistance and attempted to intergrate as slow as possible by implementing things like unfair, harsh testing for Black students to be accepted and desegregating schools one school year at a time to make the process as slow as possible. Therefore, I mostly agree with Interpretation 1 because it highlights how southern states were still heavily discriminatory and used ~~every~~ any means possible to prevent desegregation. These methods included deliberate pedanticness, taking advantage of there being no required date for desegregation, enforcing biased entry requirements and violence. Interpretation 1 also states that " as a screaming [...] entering the school." From my own knowledge, I know this is accurate because the Black students were advised to skip the first day of school by the NAACP to avoid violence

from the mob ~~of parents~~ as well as ~~250~~ the 250 state troops that ~~the~~ Governor Faubus called in to prevent the nine Black teenagers from entering. As well as this, Elizabeth Eckford (one of the nine) was faced with the "screaming mob" as she arrived alone and was faced with hundreds of white people screaming "lynch her!". So, I mostly agree with Interpretation 1 because it emphasises how Black Americans still faced severe discrimination in ~~education~~ the education system due to the prejudice and discrimination of white officials. Overall, I mostly agree with Interpretation 1 because whilst it doesn't acknowledge the progress made in other areas of the USA, it successfully and truthfully highlights how discrimination in the deep South ~~it~~ prevented ~~Black Americans~~ any hope at progress in civil equality in education for Black Americans.

I partially agree with Interpretation 2 about the progress ~~in~~ in education for Black Americans from 1954-62. Interpretation 2 states " when James Meredith [...] President Kennedy's government". From my own knowledge, I know this is accurate because after being unjustly rejected from the University of Mississippi, Meredith's case became very public and forced Kennedy to order his admission into the university, as well as providing soldiers to protect Meredith from any violence

he received at the ~~the~~ university. Therefore, I partially agree with Interpretation 2 because the perseverance of the NAACP and ~~some~~ on the risk of global embarrassment forced government officials to push for progress in the education system and ~~other~~ encouraged further integration to avoid further humiliation. Interpretation 2 also states that ~~it~~ " This then encouraged other Black students to apply to study at university." From my own knowledge, I know this is true because Black students across the USA (especially Southern States) ,were inspired by Meredith and wanted to push themselves to receive higher education, however this did not mean that their dreams became reality as there was still ~~significant~~ institutional ~~race race~~ and ~~state state~~ national racism that prevented large-scale ~~fast~~ progress being made. So, I ~~mostly disagree~~ partially agree with Interpretation 2 because it does truthfully point out ~~so~~ the successes in ~~so~~ the progression of education however it is clear that these successes ~~are it~~ were not large enough to diminish the discrimination of white leaders. Overall, I mostly disagree with Interpretation 2 because whilst it does give valid views towards the success of the James Meredith case, it does not point out that no matter how many laws or acts are passed, racist leaders and individuals ~~with~~ would always find a way to ensure that as little change happened as possible,

and whilst many young people may have felt inspired and encouraged by James Meredith, their ambition was unfortunately not always enough to overcome the discrimination they faced.

In conclusion, I mostly disagree with Interpretation 2 about the progress ~~=~~ in education per Black Americans from 1954-62 because whilst it importantly does discuss the ~~successes~~ forward progression it does not provide the unfair reality that ~~prejudice~~ prejudiced was still a ~~big~~ major issue that made progress stagnant like Interpretation 1 does.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Comments

This is a high Level 4 response as Level 4 has been achieved in all of the strands of the mark scheme for AO4. There is a sustained evaluation and a substantiated judgement. The answer analyses both interpretations and deploys this material to support the evaluation. On page 2, the answer does indicate how the differences in view are conveyed, by referring to the historian emphasising the discrimination still faced by Black Americans in education. Relevant contextual knowledge has been precisely selected to support the evaluation.

ResultsPlus

Examiner Tip

Contextual knowledge should be integrated into the evaluation of the interpretation, not offered as information or as the candidate's answer to the enquiry.

Paper Summary

Examiners commented that there were a number of impressive answers where candidates seemed well-prepared and demonstrated excellent knowledge being deployed to support thoughtful analysis and evaluation.

The following points should be noted:

· While there was good knowledge of some topics, candidates cannot rely on knowing just a few key topics and hoping to use that information whatever question is asked.

· Inferences are not the same as comprehension and candidates should avoid merely describing what they see or re-wording what they read.

· Candidates need to recognise the specific focus of the question so that the information being offered is shaped to meet the demands of the question rather than simply describing a situation or including irrelevant material.

· Candidates should appreciate the difference between sources and interpretations and be aware that interpretations are constructed by historians in order to offer their view of events.

· In all parts of Question 3, it is helpful to be explicit about the source or interpretation being discussed.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar were broadly accurate and many answers used specialist terms with confidence but a poor standard of handwriting made a number of answers difficult to mark and exacerbated the difficulty in understanding a badly-expressed answer.

The SPaGST marks may be affected if there are weaknesses in these areas:

· Appropriate use of capital letters

· Correct use of apostrophes

· Weak grammar ('would of', 'based off of') and casual language, which is not appropriate in an examination

· Paragraphs: failure to structure answers in paragraphs not only affects the SPaGST mark, but may also make it difficult for the examiner to identify whether three different aspects have been covered in question 2, or how well analysis and evaluation is developed in question 3.

If extra paper is taken, candidates should state clearly in the answer space for the question that it has been continued elsewhere and it should be stated where the rest of the answer had been written; this should be on an additional sheet rather than elsewhere in the answer booklet and should be clearly labelled. However, in many cases where additional paper had been taken, the marks had already been attained within the space provided rather than on the extra paper and candidates should be discouraged from assuming that lengthy answers will automatically score highly. Indeed, candidates taking extra paper sometimes ran out of time on the final, high mark question and therefore disadvantaged themselves.

Grade boundaries

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